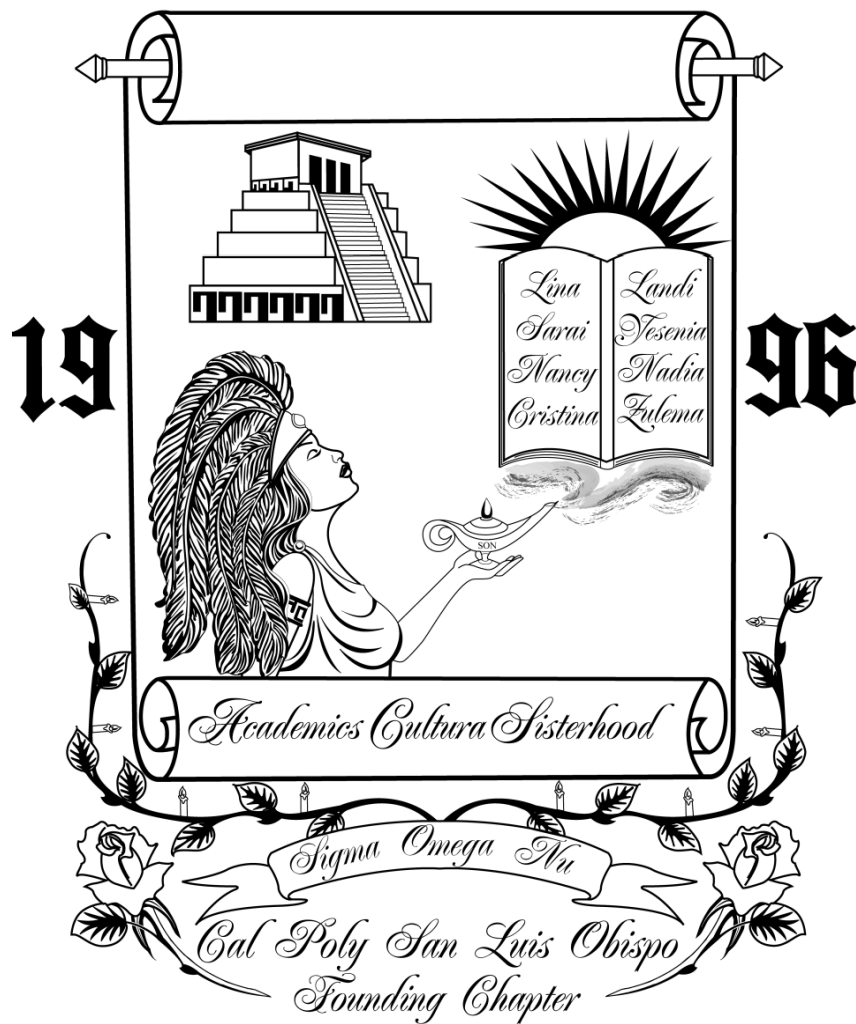


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Sigma Omega Nu

Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



Chapter Bylaws

Chapter Bylaws

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Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. Chapter Bylaws

Article I. Preamble

Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. was established at California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo by eight young women as a way to unite and involve its members in a bond of sisterhood through cultural, academic and social means. It is the intent of the organization to abide by the pertinent University regulations.

Article II. Mission Statement

Sigma Omega Nu is an organization that is built on academics, cultura, and sisterhood. Sigma Omega Nu provides a support system, cultura awareness, and a long-live sisterhood. It is a comfort zone where respect, accountability, and compassion are given and learned for womxn and the community.

Article III. Vision Statement

Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. offers a unique sisterly experience for empowering womxn, by creating scholastic excellence, bringing cultura awareness, and providing a sisterhood bond in higher education.

Article IV. Purpose

The purpose of this Sorority shall be to strive for sisterhood, scholastic excellence, self- improvement, and Latina awareness and provide community service on the University Campus of very corresponding Chapter, as well as in the community.

Article V. Identification

Section A. Organization Identification

The official name of this sorority is Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. This name may be used interchangeably with Sigma Omega Nu, or the Greek letters ΣΩΝ. The name Sigma Omega Nu shall be used in the remainder of this document. The informal nicknames of “SON” and “Sunnies” may also be used to identify the Sorority, however these nicknames may only be used for informal identification purposes only.

Section B. Definitions

The following definitions shall also be used in the remainder of this document.

1. National Board: The collective term used to refer to the National Board Members
2. Chapters: The collective term used to refer to Sigma Omega Nu's Undergraduate and Alumnae Chapters.
3. Active Members: Those members currently enrolled at a university where an Undergraduate Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists and who currently hold Active Status at their respective Chapter. See Article VI. Membership Section B. Active Status
4. Inactive Members: Those members currently enrolled at a university where an Undergraduate Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists and who currently hold Inactive Status at their respective Chapter. See Article VI. Membership Section C. Inactive Status.
5. Alumnae Members: The collective term used to refer to those members who have graduated from an accredited University.
6. Chapter Active Alumnae: Those Alumnae Members who hold Active Status at an Undergraduate Chapter. See Article VI. Membership Section D. Alumnae Status
7. National Active Alumnae: Those Alumnae Members who hold Active Status at the National Level, but not at any individual Chapter. See Article VI. Membership Section D. Alumnae Status.
8. General Members: Those members who do not otherwise meet the definition of Active, Inactive, or Alumnae Members. See Article VI. Membership Section E General Member Status
9. Sigma Omega Nu Members: The collective term used to refer to any and all members of Sigma Omega Nu, regardless of status or office held.
10. Good Standing: The term used to indicate that an individual Sister or an entire Chapter is fulfilling their duties and responsibilities, regardless of status. See Article VI. Membership for duties and responsibilities required of individual Sisters.
11. Probation: The disciplinary status assigned to an individual Sister or an entire Chapter as a result of failure to perform their duties and/or fulfill their responsibilities.
12. Suspension: The disciplinary status assigned to an individual Sister or an entire Chapter as a result of failure to perform their duties and/or fulfill their responsibilities. Suspension is a more severe status than Probation. See Article XVI. Suspension in these Chapter Bylaws and Article XVI. Chapters in the National Board Bylaws for additional information.
13. Deactivation: The process through which a Sister is no longer recognized as a member of Sigma Omega Nu. This may be voluntarily requested by the Sister, or may be imposed by the Sorority as a disciplinary sanction following a Judicial Review.
14. Simple Majority: During a meeting in which a quorum is present, a simple majority vote means 51% of those eligible to vote.
15. Plurality of Votes: In an election, the candidate that receives the most votes, even if not the majority.

Article VI. Membership

Section A. Requirements for Membership

Membership is open to all those identifying as women who believe in and support the objectives of Sigma Omega Nu. Sigma Omega Nu does not discriminate against on the basis of race, religion, creed, sexual preferences, political affiliation, appearance or disabilities. All individuals interested in joining Sigma Omega Nu must undergo a period of Pledgeship.

This organization or any of its members shall not conspire to commit any act, which causes or is likely to cause bodily danger or physical or emotional harm to any member of the campus community, surrounding communities, and/or any other member(s) of the Sorority. Such acts will result in formal Judicial Review.

1. Enrollment. All undergraduates must be registered as full-time students, and graduate students must

be registered at least half-time at the corresponding University of the Chapter that they intend on joining.

2. Minimum Grade Point Average. All potential members and initiated members of Sigma Omega Nu must maintain a minimum term grade point average of 2.3 and a minimum cumulative grade point average of 2.5 or higher AND must be in good academic standing with the University where the Chapter is established.
3. University Requirements. If the University at which the Chapter is established has additional or more stringent requirements for member of Greek life above and beyond those required by Sigma Omega Nut, those requirements must be abided by. This may include, but is not limited to a higher minimum grade point average, having completed a set number of academic terms before pledgeship, etc.

Section B. Active Status

All members are considered fully Active from the date of their crossing, unless otherwise allowed.

1. Requirements
 - a. All Active Members must maintain a minimum term grade point average of 2.3 and a minimum cumulative grade point average of 2.5 or higher and must be in Good Academic Standing with the University.
 - b. Undergraduate members are required to be enrolled full-time and graduate students are required to be enrolled at least half-time at the University where the Chapter is established.
 - c. If a member joins Sigma Omega Nu as an undergraduate, and pursues post-baccalaureate or graduate studies at a university where a Chapter is established, she is not required to be an Active member of the Chapter. However, they are encouraged to remain Active during the course of their studies.
2. Rights, Responsibilities and Duties
 - a. Active Members are granted full rights without restriction to discuss and debate during General Meetings; vote; elect officers; hold an officer or chair position; and attend Sorority events and activities.
 - b. Active Members are responsible for remaining in Good Standing by:
 - i. Actively participating in all Chapter events and activities, including General Meetings, emergency meetings, Meetings of the Minds, elections, fundraising events, community service, philanthropy events, rush & recruitment events, pledgeship events & activities, and other events deemed mandatory by the Chapter, including events or activities required by Chapter Standards.
 - ii. Actively participating in any other event or activity deemed mandatory by the Chapter, after having been designated as a mandatory event or activity with a simple majority vote.
 - iii. Paying all dues and fines such that she has a clear account balance at the start of each quarter/semester.
 - iv. Completing 30 hours of community service each year (10 hours per quarter or 15 hours per semester). Of the 30 hours, 10 hours must be dedicated to the specified Chapter philanthropy.
 - v. Completing 6 library study hours per week, and document as required by the Vice President
 - vi. Submitting all class schedules, transcripts, progress reports and any other academic information requested by the Vice President.
 - vii. Faithfully executing the duties of any office or committee chair positions held.
 - viii. Abiding by all Bylaws, Standing Rules, and Policies established by Sigma Omega Nu.

- c. In the event a Sister is unable to attend a mandatory event or activity, she is responsible for submitting a Letter of Excuse to the Sergeant at Arms a minimum of twenty-four (24) hours prior to the event. The Letter will be read and voted on at the next General Meeting. A simple majority is required to approve the letter and excuse the absence. If the Letter is not approved, the Sister will be fined accordingly. See also Chapter Standing Rules, Article II.
3. Exceptions
- a. Graduating Seniors. Members who are in their final terms and are not enrolled in the required number of units identified above, are considered Active without restriction. To qualify for this exception, a member must submit a written Graduation Plan to the Chapter's Vice President by the first week of the term in which they fall below the required units. The Vice President will maintain these Graduation Plans on file, and the Executive Board may request updates if a member's graduation timeline changes. Failure to submit or update a Graduation Plan may result in a review of the member's Active Status. The Graduation Plan must include:
 - i. A list of all remaining courses required for their degree,
 - ii. The academic term(s) in which they expect to complete those courses,
 - iii. Their anticipated graduation date, and
 - iv. An explanation of their enrollment status, including any circumstances outside their control (for example, courses offered only in specific terms, prerequisite sequencing, course conflicts, or departmental restrictions).
 - b. Academic Probation with the Sorority. Members who have fallen below Sigma Omega Nu's minimum required grade point average but are still above the University's minimum required Grade Point Average, are considered Active but with restrictions. These restrictions are:
 - i. Must participate in the Chapter's Mentorship Program, and abide by all requirements of the Program.
 - ii. Ineligible to hold office or participate in committees.
 - iii. Unable to participate in Pledgeship events or activities.
 - iv. Ineligible to be selected as a Personal Big Sister.
 - v. If the Sister's GPA does not improve after two consecutive quarters/semesters, she will automatically be placed on Inactive Status for the following term. See Section C. Inactive Status below.
 - c. Off-Campus Programs. A member is relieved from attendance obligations, but otherwise considered fully Active, while participating in any University-sanctioned off-campus programs. This includes study abroad programs and co-ops or internships that require the member to relocate away from the University for the duration of the program. All other responsibilities, including financial obligations, still apply.
 - d. Personal Hardship. In the event a Sister faces personal hardship, such as financial difficulties or significant health conditions, she may be relieved of financial obligations for a period of time. She must present a letter to the Executive Board explaining her circumstances and identifying the set amount of time she is requesting to be excused from financial obligations. A $\frac{3}{4}$ majority of Executive Board is required to pass the request.
4. Honors & Recognition
- a. Gold Member. When a member of Sigma Omega Nu has been fully Active, in accordance with this Section, for eight (8) consecutive quarters or five (5) consecutive semesters after the term in which they crossed, they shall be considered a Gold Member of the Sorority.
 - i. Gold Members are exempt from paying Chapter dues for the term following their recognition. If the Member paid the full year's dues prior to being recognized as a Gold Member, the Chapter will reimburse her for the amount equivalent to one

term's dues. The Chapter is still responsible for the payment of the members' annual dues to National Board.

- ii. Gold Members shall receive a plaque from the Chapter recognizing her achievement.
- iii. The Gold Member is still required to abide by all other rights, responsibilities, and duties of an Active member.

Section C. Inactive Status

If a Sister is unable to meet the obligations of Active Status, they may be placed on Inactive Status. This status may be requested or, in certain cases, applied automatically.

1. Requesting Inactive Status

- a. A Sister may request Inactive Status for any reason. Normally, eligibility requires at least two consecutive semesters or three consecutive quarters of Active Status, not including the term in which they crossed.
- b. Exceptions: A Sister who has not yet fulfilled this minimum requirement may still request Inactive Status if personal, academic, health or financial circumstances significantly affect their ability to remain Active.
- c. Requests must be submitted in writing to the Chapter President within two weeks of the start of the academic term. Requests will be reviewed and voted on no later than the third General Meeting of the term. Approval requires a simple majority vote of the Chapter's Active members present, provided quorum has been met.
- d. The Chapter President must notify the Sister in writing of the decision regarding their Inactive Status request prior to the next General Meeting. Notification must be delivered through email, and a copy of the decision shall be retained in the Chapter's records.
- e. If a request is denied, the Sister may appeal the decision (please refer to Section E. Status Appeals).
- f. Inactive Status may not be granted for more than one semester/quarter per academic year.

2. Automatic Inactive Status

- a. A Sister on Academic Probation with the Sorority for more than two semesters/quarters will automatically be placed on Inactive Status.
- b. A Sister on Academic Probation with the University will automatically be placed on Inactive Status with the Chapter.
- c. The Chapter's Vice President must notify the Sister in writing when Automatic Inactive Status is applied.

3. Rights, Responsibilities and Duties

- a. Inactive Sisters may attend the following events/activities (with restrictions):
 - i. General Meetings (refer to Section 4)
 - ii. Community Service
 - iii. Fundraisers
 - iv. Philanthropy Events
 - v. Sisterhood Socials
 - vi. Rush Socials (refer to Section 4)
 - vii. Pinning and Crossover
- b. Inactive Sisters are responsible for remaining in Good Standing by:
 - i. Paying all dues and fines.
 - ii. Completing 30 hours of community service each academic year (10 hours per quarter or 15 hours per semester), of which 10 must be for the Chapter's designated philanthropy, and 10 towards raising awareness for and supporting survivors of sexual assault with an established organization.

- iii. Completing 6 library study hours per week, documented weekly with the Chapter's Vice President.
 - iv. Submitting all class schedules, transcripts, progress reports and any other academic information requested by the Chapter's Vice President.
 - v. Participate in the Mentorship Program, if Inactive Status is due to Academic Probation with the Sorority or University.
 - vi. Abiding by all Bylaws, Standing Rules, and Policies of Sigma Omega Nu.
- 4. Restrictions
 - a. Inactive Members are prohibited from the following:
 - i. Holding an officer or committee chair position
 - ii. Participating in committees
 - iii. Being selected as a personal Big Sister
 - b. If an Inactive Member intends to participate in General Meeting or Rush Social, they must notify the Chapter President at least 24 hours in advance of the event.
 - i. General Meetings: May attend and participate in discussions, but may not vote.
 - ii. Rush Socials: May only attend Rush socials limited to Sisters and Prospective New Members.

Section D. Disciplinary Statuses

1. Probation

A Sister on Disciplinary Probation Status is not considered in Good Standing with the Sorority for the full duration of the Probation period.

Any member may be placed in Disciplinary Probation Status as a sanction resulting from a formal Judicial Review for one of the offenses listed below.

- a. Offenses
 - i. Repeated failure to zero balance by start of each term
 - ii. Willful and knowing discrimination towards interested members.
- b. Rights, Responsibilities, and Restrictions
 - i. Must continue to pay all dues and fines.
 - ii. Must attend General Meetings, but cannot participate in discussion, debate or voting.
 - iii. Must attend any mandatory Meetings of the Mind
 - iv. Must complete weekly library study hours.
 - v. Must attend any mandatory community service, philanthropy, and fundraising events.
 - vi. Must attend a workshop or training relevant to the violations, as identified by the Judicial Review Committee
 - vii. May continue to use or wear the insignia and paraphernalia of Sigma Omega Nu
 - viii. The member will automatically be removed from any officer position(s) held.
 - ix. May continue to serve on or join any new committees, but may not be a committee chair.
 - x. Cannot attend any Rush or Pledgeship events or activities.
 - xi. May attend sisterhood socials, but cannot attend any socials held with other organizations.
 - xii. Cannot attend "parties" intended as a fundraiser event.
- c. Duration
 - i. The duration of the probation period shall be unanimously agreed upon by the Judicial Review Committee. Two weeks prior to the end of her probation period, the

member must contact the Executive Board to discuss her probation. If the member has followed the restrictions of her probation, she may regain full privileges.

- ii. If the duration of the probation lasts for more than one term, the member will return to whichever status she held prior to being placed on probation. She will be held to all rights, responsibilities, duties, and restrictions of that status for the remainder of the term.

2. Suspension

A Sister on Suspension Status is not considered in Good Standing with the Sorority for the full duration of the Suspension period.

- a. Any member may be placed in Suspension Status with privileges withdrawn for the following reasons:
 - i. As a sanction resulting from a formal Judicial Review, for one of the offenses listed below.
 - ii. If the member is suspended from the University due to inappropriate actions by the member.
 - iii. If a member is named in a sexual assault allegation or incident, they will be placed in Suspension Status for the duration of the Sexual Assault Judicial Review. See the Sexual Assault Judicial Review Procedures for additional information.
- b. Offenses. If a Judicial Review determines any of the following offenses did in fact occur, Suspension status is merited.
 - i. Physical assault of any other individual
 - ii. Sexual assault or harassment of any other individual
 - iii. Repeated refusal to pay dues owed and/or fines incurred.
- c. Restrictions
 - i. The member will automatically be removed from any officer or committee position(s) held.
 - ii. The member is prohibited from participating in any Chapter, Prospective Chapter, and National events or activities.
 - iii. The member is prohibited from using or wearing any insignia or paraphernalia of Sigma Omega Nu or its Chapters.
- d. Duration
 - i. If a member is suspended as the result of a Judicial Review, the duration of the suspension period shall be unanimously agreed upon by the Judicial Review Committee. Two weeks prior to the end of her suspension period, the member must contact the Executive Board to discuss her suspension. If the member has followed the restrictions of her suspension, she may regain full privileges.
 - ii. If a member is suspended in conjunction with suspension by the University, the duration of the suspension period shall be the same as that identified by the University. If the University removes the suspension status, the member may regain full privileges.
 - iii. If the duration of the suspension lasts for more than one term, the member will return to whichever status she held prior to being placed on suspension. She will be held to all rights, responsibilities, duties, and restrictions of that status for the remainder of the term.

Section E. Status Appeals

1. Appealing Denial of Inactive Status Request

- a. If Chapter Active Membership denies the request for Inactive Status, the member may

- appeal the request to the Executive Board for a second review of the request. The Executive Board must approve the letter with a simple majority.
 - b. If the Executive Board denies the request, the member may appeal the request to the National Board for a third review. In order for the National Board to review the request, the member must submit all previously submitted requests, along with the written reasons for denial from the Chapter and Executive Board. The determination of the National Board will be considered final.
2. **Appealing Disciplinary Status**
- a. Appeals of Probation Status or Suspension Status must follow the appeal process outlines in the Judicial Review process.

Section F. Transfers

A Sister may transfer her Active Status to another Chapter under two conditions:

- 1. The Sister transfers to another University where another Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists.
- 2. The Sister transfers to another University that is within the local commuting area of another University where a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists.

The following process must be followed in order for a Sister to transfer her Active Status to another Chapter.

- 1. The Sister must pay all outstanding dues and fines owed to her initiating Chapter, return any Chapter property, and complete any required transition meetings.
- 2. The Sister must submit a letter to the Executive Board of her initiating Chapter notifying them of the transfer to another University, including her date of transfer, and the intent to transfer to another Chapter. This letter must be submitted no later than the second to last meeting of the quarter or semester prior to the transfer. No vote is required for this letter.
- 3. The Sister must submit a letter to the Executive Board of the Chapter at the University she will be transferring to notifying them of the transfer to their university, including the date of transfer, and requesting Active Status with the Chapter. This letter must be submitted no later than the second to last meeting of the quarter or semester prior to the transfer. No vote is required for this letter, but the Executive Board of the transfer Chapter is required to notify its Chapter Membership of the transfer.
- 4. The Executive Board of the initiating Chapter will submit a letter to the Executive Board of the transfer Chapter notifying the transfer Chapter that the Sister has completed all requirements in order to transfer. Once this letter is received, the Executive Board of the transfer Chapter will add the member to any Chapter distribution lists, group chats, etc. and notify the member of the date, time, and location of the next General Meeting.
- 5. Once the member has been accepted as an Active member of the transfer Chapter, the Executive Board of the transfer Chapter must submit a letter to the Executive Board of the initiating Chapter stating that the transfer has been complete.
- 6. The Sister who has transferred to another University and Chapter must continue to provide updated contact and degree information to her initiating Chapter.

It is the responsibility of the member transferring and the Executive Board of both Chapters to complete this process and keep all records accordingly.

Any Sister who transfers to another Chapter will still remain on the Chapter member roster of her initiating Chapter and retain her crossing information from that Chapter. She will not be added to the scroll of the transfer Chapter, but must be added to the Chapter Active Roster submitted to National Board.

Section G. Alumnae Status

1. Requirements
 - a. In order to be considered an Alumna of Sigma Omega Nu, one must have completed all undergraduate and/or graduate courses and have received a diploma from an accredited four- year University.
2. Rights, Responsibilities, and Duties
 - a. Alumnae are responsible for remaining in Good Standing by:
 - i. Maintaining a clear balance with any Chapter(s) previously affiliated with
 - ii. Providing updated contact, graduation, and degree information with her initiating Chapter.
 - iii. Paying for her to participate in all Sigma Omega Nu activities, when required.
3. Restrictions
 - a. If an Alumna Member intends to participate in any Chapter event, including General Meetings, she must notify the Chapter President of her intent to participate at least 24 hours in advance of the event.
 - b. Alumnae Members may attend General Meetings, but are not allowed to participate in discussion, debate, or voting.
4. Chapter Active Alumnae
 - a. Alumnae who desire to maintain Active Status at an Undergraduate Chapter are required to submit a letter requesting Active Status within the first two weeks of each term. A simple majority vote of the Active Membership is needed for letter to pass. If the request is denied, there is no appeal process.
 - b. Active Alumnae must abide by all of the requirements and expectations of an Active Member as identified in Section B. Active Status above, except for the enrollment requirements. Additionally, Active Alumnae must abide by any requirements and restrictions imposed by the University with regards to Active Alumnae.
 - c. Chapter Active Alumnae dues will be determined by the Chapter, in accordance with Article XII. Finances, Section A. Dues. Half of this amount shall go towards the Academic Honor Society Scholarship.
5. National Active Alumnae
 - a. Alumnae who desire to maintain Active Status with the Organization but not at an Undergraduate Chapter may request National Active Status from the National Board.
 - b. National Active Alumnae status does not also grant the member Chapter Active Alumnae status. If the member wishes to also hold Chapter Active Alumnae Status, she must request that through the individual Chapter, as outlined above.
 - c. National Active Alumnae dues are determined by the National Board. 25% of National Alumnae Dues shall go towards the Annual National Board Scholarship Fund, with the remainder going towards the National general fund.
 - d. Dues for National Active Alumnae are to be paid directly to the National Vice President of Finance. See the National Board Bylaws for National Active Alumnae dues amounts.

Section H. General Member Status

A Sister will be considered a General Member of the Sorority if she does not meet any of the requirements of Active, Inactive or Alumnae Status.

1. Requirements
 - a. This status will be automatically applied if:
 - i. The Sister transfers to a four-year University that is not in close proximity to a university where a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu is established.
 - ii. The Sister is exclusively attending a local junior, community or vocational college.

- iii. The Sister did not graduate from a four-year University.
- 2. Rights, Responsibilities, and Duties
 - a. General Members are responsible for remaining in Good Standing by:
 - i. Maintaining a clear balance with any Chapter(s) previously affiliated with
 - ii. Providing updated contact, graduation, and degree information with her initiating Chapter.
 - iii. Paying for her participation in all Sigma Omega Nu activities, when required.
- 3. Restrictions
 - a. If a General Member intends on participating in any Chapter Event, including General Meetings, she must notify the Chapter President of her intent to participate at least 24 hours in advance of the event.
 - b. General Members may attend General Meetings, but are not allowed to participate in discussion, debate, or vote.

Section I. New Members

1. After becoming a New Member, the New Class must remove the cover sheet from their binder, and replace it with one that has the Greek Letters ΣΩΝ somewhere on it.
2. Before the next general meeting, the Pledge Mothers will hold the Post Pledgeship Workshop with the New Members to review the Chapter Bylaws and Chapter Standing Rules, as well as explain how a general meeting is held. See also Standardized Chapter Pledgeship, Article XX. New Members.
3. At the first General Meeting after crossover, each officer will conduct her business as usual. At the conclusion of her announcements, the officer will ask the New Members if they have any questions. At the end of the meeting, the President shall ask the New Members if they have any more questions about the officers, their duties, or the general running of a meeting.
4. Should there be any vacant positions at the time, the New Members shall be nominated for any positions they are eligible to hold, and given a week to review the position description before elections.

Section J. Multiple Memberships

Members of Sigma Omega Nu may join other Greek lettered organizations as long as membership in those organizations meet the following requirements:

1. Honorary Membership: Honorary club or fraternity where membership or entitlement is given in recognition of the sister's excellence in their course of study or contributions to the University. Membership is by invitation only.
2. Professional Membership: Any member of this Sorority may join a professional, service or leadership-based co-ed fraternity. These organizations are founded on career development, community service or leadership development. They do not prohibit members of social fraternities or sororities from membership.
3. Restrictions: No member of this Sorority may be a member of any other social sorority or fraternity. Any member wishing to join one of these organizations must first complete Sigma Omega Nu's deactivation process prior to seeking membership. Those interested in joining Sigma Omega Nu must provide proof of having completed the deactivation process of any previous organization(s) prior to beginning the Sigma Omega Nu membership process.

Article VII. Officers

Section A. Officers

Sigma Omega Nu shall consist of the following sixteen officers: President, Vice President, Sergeant-At-Arms, Treasurer, Vice President of Communications, Risk Management Officer, Commissioner of Cultura

and Sisterhood, Commissioner of Community Service, Commissioner of Fundraising, Commissioner of Alumnae Relations, Commissioner of Social Affairs, Commissioner of Public Relations, Historian, Pledge Mother(s), University Representative, and National Board Representative.

Section B. Requirements of Officers

1. All officers must qualify for regular Active Status under Article IV, Section B for the elected term. Officers must also meet any requirements identified by the University regarding officers.
 - a. Those who are Active under 'Special Circumstance, Local Transfer', are eligible to hold non-Executive Board office.
 - b. Those who are Active under 'Special Circumstance, Academic Probation', are ineligible to hold any office.
2. All officers are required to have a clear account before being elected or appointed into office.
3. Officers shall not have greater voting power than any other Active Member.
4. All officers are limited to missing no more than three meetings per quarter/semester, regardless of whether or not the absence was excused. Once a fourth meeting is missed, she will be removed from all offices held.
5. Candidates for President and Treasurer must have been active for three consecutive quarters or two consecutive semesters prior to being elected.
6. The Treasurer position may only be held by one sister at a time. The position may not be shared, and co-Treasurers are not permitted.
7. The President and Treasurer positions may not be held by the same sister simultaneously.
8. Candidates for Pledge Mother must have been an Active member for the full duration of the pledgship of a class, other than their own, prior to being elected.
9. Only members enrolled at the University where the Chapter is located may serve as President, Treasurer, or Pledge Mother. Members must maintain such enrollment throughout their term. Loss of enrollment at any point during the term shall result in immediate ineligibility to continue in the position.
 - a. Chapters seeking an exception to this requirement may submit a formal appeal to the National Board for review and consideration.
10. Newly elected officers will take office in accordance with Article VIII. Elections
11. All non-Executive Board officers are required to meet with their overseer on a monthly basis to provide updates on the responsibilities and assignments. The overseer may provide feedback during these meetings.
12. All officers are responsible for preparing Tentative and Final Budgets for any events they organize that require the expenditure of funds. See Article XIII. Finances for more information.
13. All officers shall keep an updated physical or electronic binder regarding their duties, obligations, and past records/files pertinent to the position which shall be passed onto their successor once the newly elected officers take office or whenever a change in office occurs.
14. All officers must complete the Chapter Standards requirements assigned to them, and submit to the Chapter President and Vice President the required forms and/or documentation for each assigned requirement no later than two weeks after the end of each quarter/semester. See Chapter Standards for requirements assigned to each officer.

Section C. Executive Board

1. The Executive Board shall consist of the following six positions: President, Vice President, Sergeant-At-Arms, Treasurer, Vice President of Communications, and Risk Management Officer.
2. All Executive Board officers are required to attend any and all workshops or training required by the University in order for the Sorority to be recognized as an organization on campus.

Section D. Officer Descriptions

1. President

The President shall:

- Be a member of the Executive Board.
- Be active for three consecutive quarters or two consecutive semesters prior to being elected.
- Work with the Executive Board to come up with a set of goals for the coming academic year.
- Preside over all meetings and functions.
- Provide supervision for the Chapter and its officers.
- Ensure that all the required duties and obligations are being fulfilled by the Active Membership.
- Be an ex-officio member of all committees.
- Have the power to call special meetings, emergency meetings, delegate new projects, and appoint any special committees.
- Appoint a Vice President of Communications and/or Sergeant-At-Arms for the duration of a General Meeting if the elected officers are absent.
- Have the authority to make monetary transactions only when specifically authorized by the Treasurer.
- Be able to inform members of the account balance and pending budgets whenever the Treasurer is not present at the meetings.
- Provide financial oversight of the Chapter by reviewing the Treasurer's financial records and reports on a regular basis and verifying the Chapter's financial books prior to submission to the National Vice President of Finance.
- Represent the Chapter to the National Board when required.
- Following National Council meetings, support the elected National Board Representative in distribution and review of National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
- Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
- Specifically advise the Pledge Mother(s), the University Representative, and the National Board Representative(s).

2. Vice President

The Vice President shall:

- Be a member of the Executive Board.
- Perform all presidential duties in the absence of the President.
- Carry out any other assignments that the President may see fit.
- Have on file all currently enrolled members' majors, courses, current course schedule, and work schedules.
- Collect and keep on file quarter/semester grades and GPAs of all currently enrolled members.
- Schedule due dates of Progress Reports, and notify membership of this date.
- Oversee the Mentorship Program and ensure that Sisters who are on Academic Probation with the University or the Sorority are completing the requirements.
- Collect and keep on file the completion of weekly library study hours per each Active and Inactive member, notifying members of the required form of documentation.

- Reward members who excel in their academic and profession development through some form of recognition.
 - Recognize Alpha Order inductees each quarter/semester.
 - Present the Alpha Order Recipient plaque and Academic Honor Society scholarship at the end of the academic year.
 - Organize and coordinate that at least 80% of the chapter attends one workshop/event per term that promotes academic or professional development.
 - Represent the Chapter to the National Board when the President is required to do so and is unable to.
 - Coordinate and ensure that Sisters attend a Substance Abuse Workshop.
 - Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
 - Specifically advise the Commissioner of Social Affairs and the Commissioner of Alumnae Relations.
3. Sergeant-At-Arms
- The Sergeant-At-Arms shall:
- Be a member of the Executive Board
 - Be responsible for ensuring Chapter Bylaws are followed at all times.
 - Keep order at all meetings.
 - Keep General Meetings to a maximum of one hour and a half unless she motions to extend the meeting and it is approved through a majority vote by the Active Membership.
 - Follow the agenda closely and keep issues in focus.
 - Keep a record of absences, tardiness, and letters of excuse.
 - Enforce all penalties and fines and report them to the Treasurer weekly.
 - Give pop quizzes, at any time, regarding pertinent Sigma Omega Nu information.
 - When there is a pledge class: Administer and ensure that Pledge Mothers, Pledge Committee members, and any additional active sisters conducting oral quizzes have passed both a written and an oral quiz with a minimum score of 80%. These tests must cover all testable material for Little Sisters; members may not choose which material they are tested on. If a sister does not meet the minimum score requirements, there will be no retakes, and she must sit out from conducting oral quizzes during that pledge meeting.
 - Run all chapter elections.
 - Oversee all Judicial Review proceedings.
 - Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
 - Specifically advise the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood, the Commissioner of Community Service, and the Historian.
4. Treasurer
- The Treasurer shall:
- Be a member of the Executive Board.
 - Have the authority to make monetary transactions using the Chapter account in accordance with

the $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the Active Membership.

- Collect all membership dues and outstanding balances.
- Collect, maintain, and keep accurate records of all Chapter funds, financial transactions, and cash flow.
- Be responsible for the transport and security of the cash box and shall be held liable for the money in the box.
- Immediately inform the President of any lost or misplaced funds and report this to the other members at the next general meeting
- Maintain current financial account records for all members and provide updated member account statements at the first General Meeting of each month.
- Establish and administer Financial Contracts requested by members or Little Sisters.
- Maintain the Chapter financial books, checkbook, and financial records in an accurate and up to date manner and provide weekly Chapter account balances at General Meetings.
- Review all budgets, requests for funds and reimbursements submitted by the Active Membership and act on them accordingly.
- Inform Active Membership of the status of the Chapter account, including tentative and approved budgets.
- Issue reimbursements only for purchases that were previously approved through the budgeting process and supported by appropriate receipts submitted within two weeks of purchase.
- Prepare an annual operating budget prior to the beginning of each academic year and update project budgets as needed at the beginning of each quarter/semester.
- At the conclusion of each quarter/semester and at the end of the academic year, prepare a financial report comparing the projected and approved expenditures to actual expenditures.
- Maintain financial records in a manner that is organized, complete, and available for review by the Chapter President and for submission to the National Vice President of Finance upon request, and no later than January 1st of each year.
- Present financial records and reports to the Chapter President for periodic review to ensure financial transparency and accountability.
- Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
- Specifically advise the Commissioner of Fundraising.

5. Vice President of Communications

The Vice President of Communications shall:

- Be a member of the Executive Board
- Prepare and agenda, in coordination with the Chapter President, prior to each meeting.
- Distribute electronic or physical copies of meetings agenda prior to each meeting.
- Take minutes during all meetings, and keep copies of approved minutes on file for Active Membership
- Be responsible for printing and distribution of election ballots.
- Be responsible for printing and distribution of any Sorority or Chapter documents, when requested.
- Update Chapter member roster and Officer/Active roster at the start of each quarter/semester, and submit to the National Vice President of Communications when requested.

- Maintain an up-to-date calendar of Chapter events and activities.
 - Be responsible for establishment and maintenance of the Chapter email account.
 - Be responsible for checking the mailbox (if required by the University) and Chapter email account weekly.
 - Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
 - Oversee the Commissioner of Public Relations
6. Risk Management Officer
- The Risk Management Officer shall:
- Be knowledgeable about and enforce all University policies, with specific attention to the following policies: Alcohol/Drug, Hazing, Title IX and Discrimination.
 - Be knowledgeable about and enforce all Sigma Omega Nu policies, with specific attention to the following policies: Alcohol/Drug Hazing, Risk Management, Sexual Misconduct, and Discrimination.
 - Prior to each event, assess potential risks and identify mitigations in accordance with University and Sorority policies to ensure members' well-being and safety.
 - Complete and keep on file a risk assessment checklist (provided by National Board) for each chapter event/activity. Risk assessment checklist will include potential risks, potential mitigations, and potential impacts.
 - Promote awareness and education through planned events and activities dealing with issues the chapter might be facing regarding health, wellness, and safety.
 - Coordinate that Sisters attend the following workshops required by Chapter Standards: Substance Abuse Workshop and Sexual Assault Awareness Event.
 - Act as a Chapter Representative on the Risk Management Committee when the committee is called by the National Vice President of Risk Management.
 - Serve as the point of contact on all risk management issues and update the chapter as appropriate.
 - Alongside the Chapter President, be responsible for handling all risk management issues and filling out any applicable incident/accident reports (when necessary) to the University and National Board.
 - Collect and provide a working list of resources, both on and off campus, and make it available to all Chapter members.
 - Responsible for keeping the National Vice President of Risk Management up to date on Risk Management matters and reaching out for guidance.
 - Responsible for submitting the third-party alcohol provider verification to National Vice President of Risk Management a minimum of six weeks prior to any event at which alcohol will be or is anticipated to be served.
 - Attend National Council meetings as the Chapter Representative when designated to serve as the proxy. When serving in this capacity, assist the elected National Board Representative with the distribution and review of the National Council meeting minutes at the next Chapter General Meeting.
7. Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood
- The Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood shall:

- Be responsible for identifying and/or planning a cultural event once every quarter/semester. The Active Membership must attend the cultural event. The cultural event shall be one that promotes diversity and cultural difference within the Sorority and the community.
 - Plan the chapter's yearly Parent's Banquet
 - Be responsible in the planning of all retreats.
 - Plan at minimum one sisterhood social per quarter/semester.
 - Award a Sister of the Month each month, keep records on the Sister of the Month Spreadsheet.
 - Ensure all ceremonies follow the appropriate requirements.
8. Commissioner of Community Service
The Commissioner of Community Service shall:
- Be responsible for informing the Active Membership of five to ten upcoming community service activities per academic term.
 - Keep a record of community service hours completed by each Active Member.
 - Assign makeup projects for members who do not complete the required community service hours at the end of each academic term.
 - Set up two mandatory events per academic year with the Chapter Philanthropy.
 - Work with the Commissioner of Fundraising to organize a minimum of one event per academic year that raises funds for the Chapter Philanthropy.
 - Recognize the Active Member with the most hours of community service completed with a framed certificate each quarter/semester.
 - Recognize the Active Member who completed the most community service hours for the past academic year at the annual formal in the form of a framed certificate or plaque.
9. Commissioner of Fundraising
The Commissioner of Fundraising shall:
- Work closely with the Treasurer on all monetary matters.
 - Be responsible for the distribution and collection of any tickets or fundraising items.
 - In the absence of the Treasurer during a fundraiser, shall be responsible for the transport and security of the cash box and shall be liable for the money in the box.
 - Seek new ideas for fundraising and coordinate at least one fundraising event per quarter or two per semester.
10. Commissioner of Alumnae Relations
The Commissioner of Alumnae Relations shall:
- Request updated Alumnae contact information at the start of each for inclusion in the Chapter member roster, and provide to the Vice President of Communications when received.
 - Coordinate a minimum of one alumnae event per academic school year which may overlap with Chapter Anniversaries or University Alumni Weekends
 - Work with the Commissioner of Public Relations to produce two newsletters per quarter/semester for alumnae.
 - Be the liaison to the regional Alumnae Chapter (if one is established).
11. Commissioner of Social Affairs
The Commissioner of Social Affairs shall:
- Coordinate a minimum of three social events per academic school year which may include socials between chapters of Sigma Omega Nu and other University Affiliated campus organizations. These are separate from the Sisterhood socials organized by the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood.

- Assist Pledge Mothers with coordinating and scheduling social held with other organizations during rush.
 - Assist the Vice President of Communications with managing the Chapter calendar.
 - Ensure that all social events follow all Sorority and University policies, regulations and protocols.
12. Commissioner of Public Relations
- The Commissioner of Public Relations shall:
- Be in charge of designing all marketing content for the Sorority, including but not limited to fundraisers, rush flyers, community service, and announcements across platforms.
 - Maintain the Sigma Omega Nu Chapter website and any other social media accounts in accordance with all regulations and bylaws.
 - Monitor that chapter and chapter affiliated social media content is relevant to the mission and objectives of the Sorority.
 - Promote and highlight achievements of chapter sisters, regardless of Active Status, in areas of academics, cultura, sisterhood, community service, leadership and career development.
 - Assist the chapter with marketing needs including internal announcements.
 - Be responsible for sending information to the National Board for national publicity requests.
13. Historian
- The Historian shall:
- Be responsible for taking pictures at every official event unless specifically asked not to.
 - Develop, print, or duplicate photos when necessary.
 - Contact a photographer for composites and social events.
 - Create one scrapbook per academic school year and present it to the Chapter at the Formal or Anniversary event.
 - Keep an organized library of records, photo albums, etc.
 - Keep accurate track of the Sorority's property.
 - Make sure that the Banner is at all functions unless otherwise specified.
 - Maintain an updated profile of every member of the Chapter, and provide an updated copy to the National Archivist at the end of each academic year.
14. Pledge Mother(s)
- The Pledge Mother(s) shall:
- Plan and execute all weekly meetings, activities and events throughout the Little Sister Process, in accordance with Standardized Pledgeship.
 - Abide by all requirements of the Standardized Pledgeship.
15. University Representative
- The University Representative shall:
- Be the liaison between the Chapter and any University affairs, Greek Councils, or student government(s) in which Sigma Omega Nu must or should be represented or belong to on campus.
 - Attend the required meetings and report back to the Active Membership at the next General Meeting
 - Represent the Chapter at all mandatory events, as required by the University.
16. National Board Representative
- The National Board Representative shall:
- Be the liaison between the Chapter and the National Board of Sigma Omega Nu.

- Be tested by the National Vice President of Parliament on the National Board Bylaws and Standing Rules prior to taking office.
- Be subject to all rules, regulations and requirements of a National Board member as specified in the National Board Bylaws.
- Serve on National Judicial Review Committees, when selected.
- Attend all National Council meetings at which the presence of a Chapter Representative is required. When the presence of a Chapter Representative is required at National or Prospective Chapter events, there is no restriction on which Chapter member can serve as the Chapter Representative, and any member qualified to participate in National or Prospective Chapter events may attend as the designated Chapter Representative.
- Inform the Chapter when she is unable to attend a National meeting or event and submit a letter of excuse to the Chapter Sergeant at Arms to request to be excused.
- Immediately distribute any proposals being considered at the subsequent National Council meeting once received from the National Board.
- Be responsible for voting on proposals during the National Council meeting in accordance with the wishes of the Chapter.
- Distribute National Council meeting minutes to all Chapter members following each National Council meeting, and review what was discussed, including the outcomes of proposals, at the next Chapter General Meeting.
- Submit Chapter Reports to the National Vice President of Communications when requested.

Article VIII. Elections

Section A. Nominations

Nominations will begin on April 15th of each year. Members wishing to be nominated for an office are not required to be present for nominations.

Nominations shall be conducted as follows:

1. At the General Meeting on or immediately after April 15th, the Sergeant-At-Arms shall declare the opening of nominations for officers for the upcoming academic school year.
2. Sergeant-At-Arms shall state all the officers as listed in Article VII. Section A, above.
3. Active Members will nominate members for each position listed by the Sergeant-At Arms.
4. Members nominated may choose to accept or decline the nomination at the time of nomination. If accepted, the member's name shall be put on the election ballot. If the nominee is not present, their name shall go on the ballot.
5. Nominations will remain open up to the time of voting.

Section B. Elections

Elections must be completed prior to May 1st of each year. Elections shall be conducted as follows:

1. At the General meeting on or immediately before May 1st, the Sergeant-At-Arms shall request any additional nominations for officers for the upcoming academic school year.
2. Active members will continue nominations if necessary.
3. Members already on the election ballot will be asked once again prior to elections if they accept their nomination. Members must be present on the day of elections. If the member is not present their name will automatically be removed from the ballot.
4. Before voting commences, nominees shall give a speech addressing their plans, goals, etc. for their nominated position(s).

5. Elections will occur by secret ballot. Each member will have a sheet of paper which lists each position and the nominees. They will then be required to select one name under each position.
6. After the Active Members have voted the Sergeant-At-Arms will collect all the ballots.
7. The Sergeant-At-Arms and President will step outside the room and count the votes for each position.
8. A plurality of votes is needed for a nominated member to win office.
9. After the votes have been counted and each position has an elected officer, the President will announce the new officers for the following academic school year.
10. In case of a tie, the Sergeant-At-Arms should follow the same election process, and the Active Members shall vote between the tied members.
11. In the event of a single nominee for any given office, a speech must still be presented, and voting shall take place as usual.
12. A vote of 'no confidence' can be made for a particular office when a member does not have confidence that those nominated will successfully fulfill the duties of the office. If a plurality of the votes is for 'no confidence', then nominations and elections shall begin again following announcement of the other offices.

Section C. Term

All Chapter officers who are elected shall serve for a term of one academic school year commencing on May 1st in the year they are elected and ending on April 30th of the following year. Pledge Mother(s) shall be elected each term that the Chapter chooses to pledge. The Pledge Mother(s) shall hold the office until the Pledge Class is initiated.

Section D. Re-election

All Chapter Officers shall be eligible for re-election to a second term, but no officer shall hold the same office for more than two consecutive terms.

Article IX. Vacancies and Resignations

Section A. Vacancies

If an office is left vacant, the President may appoint a member that is interested in taking the responsibilities of the specified position. If an eligible Active Member volunteers to fill the vacancy that member may automatically take the position if there is no objection. If there is more than one interested member, the Active Membership shall immediately fill the vacancy with an election. Appointees must meet all other requirements of officers identified in Article VII. Officers, prior to being appointed.

Section B. Resignation

Resignation from office may be accepted in emergency cases or special circumstances only. Any member vacating her position after she has already accepted the responsibility to take office may present her reasons for doing so to the Executive Board. The process for resignation is as follows:

1. If a member is resigning her position, she has to set up a meeting with the Active Membership.
2. She will orally present her reasons for resigning her position and give each member on the Executive Board a written letter explaining her resignation as well.
3. After the Active Membership has given the explanation, they will follow with a deliberation and vote on whether the member shall be penalized for vacating the office.
4. If the Active Membership feels that the member shall be penalized, the penalty given shall prohibit the member from holding any office within Sigma Omega Nu for a period of one year, effective immediately.

Article X. Officer Removal

Section A. Removal

1. Any officer may be removed from office for the following reasons:
 - a. Missing more than three meetings in a quarter/semester, whether or not the absence was excused.
 - b. As a sanction resulting from a formal Judicial Review. However, removal from office can only be used as a sanction when the results of the Judicial Review demonstrated that the officer significantly failed to meet the duties and responsibilities of her office.
2. A member who was removed from office does not lose her Active Status if she still qualifies for Active Status according to Article IV, Section B.
3. A member who was removed from office may not fill any other vacant office for the remainder of the academic year, but may be nominated during the annual Chapter nominations to be elected for office for the following academic year.

Section B. Appeal

Any member who has been removed from office may appeal the decision to the National Board through the Judicial Review Appeal process.

Article XI. Meetings

Section A. General Meetings

Sigma Omega Nu Chapter General Meetings shall be held once per week. The General Meetings shall be held on campus if possible or held in such places as the Executive Board sees fit. After the General Meeting has been called to order, the Founders Chant shall be recited. For Founders Chant, see Standing Rules.

Section B. Quorum

A quorum of two-thirds (2/3) of Active Members shall be required to vote on any matter. If quorum is not met, no voting shall take place.

Section C. Emergency Meetings

In the case of a pressing matter, only the President or Vice President may call an emergency meeting and must notify all Actives. A twenty-four (24) hour notice shall be given.

Section D. Executive Board Meetings

The Chapter's Executive Board shall meet a minimum of once a month. Executive Board Meetings shall be closed to all other members. Minutes from Executive Board meetings are not available to any member outside of Executive Board.

Section E. Robert's Rules of Order

Robert's Rules of Order shall be referred to for all parliamentary procedures not covered by the Bylaws.

Section F. Office Agenda Addition

It shall be the responsibility of each officer and member eligible to participate in meetings to contact the Vice President of Communications at least 24 hours prior to any scheduled meeting to be included on the agenda.

Section G. President and Vice President Absence

In the event that both the President and the Vice President are unable to attend or will be late to a meeting, the Sergeant at Arms shall conduct the meeting.

Section H. Meeting Attire

All chapter meetings shall be in business casual attire, no exceptions.

Article XII. Committees

Section A. Committees, Committee Chair and Members

Sigma Omega Nu Committees shall be formed in order to ensure the successful completion of any special events or projects. Standing Committees shall be the Formal Committee, Parent Banquet Committee, and the Rush/Recruitment Committee.

Other special committees may be set up by any officer or active member with approval of the President. Committee members shall consist of the Active Members only.

When the Chapter hosts a National event, any committee established by the Chapter must coordinate and collaborate with the National Board officer responsible for the event and any National committee they may have established for the event.

Section B. Responsibilities of Chair

There shall be one Committee Chair per committee who shall be the direct liaison between the committee and the Active Membership. The Committee Chair shall give a status report at every general meeting and give a summary report at the general meeting following the event. The Chairperson(s) for any Committee shall at all times maintain a record of actions through receipts, photographs, and/or reports. This shall be used for reference in order to assist members in the future.

Section C. Responsibilities

1. It is the responsibility of the committee to plan and execute the special event or project as identified at the formation of the committee.
2. Committee must present a budget to the Active Membership which must be approved before any funds are allocated to the special event or project.
3. Committees shall be disbanded once the specific action or event has been completed.

Section D. Restrictions

No committee shall have the power to:

1. Take any final action on any matter(s) which require the approval of the National Board members.
2. Fill vacancies on the National Board or any committees(s)
3. Amend or appeal any Sigma Omega Nu Bylaws or adopt new bylaws.
4. Amend or appeal resolutions of the National Board
5. Create new committees.

Article XIII. Finances

Section A. Dues

1. Membership Dues Owed to the Chapter: All members of the Chapter shall be required to pay quarterly/semester membership dues. Dues shall be due at the first General Meeting of each

quarter/semester and must be paid within two weeks of the due date.

- a. Dues for members holding Active Status shall be determined by the Chapter. The National Board requires a minimum of \$400 per Sister per year.
 - b. Dues for members holding Inactive Status shall be set at \$50 for each quarter/semester.
 - c. Dues for members holding Active Alumnae Status shall be determined by the Chapter. Half of this amount shall go towards the Academic Honor Society Scholarship.
 - d. Dues for new members shall be \$100 fee per member. The due date is two weeks after the crossing date. Please attach a copy of the excel New Member Initiation form.
2. Membership Dues Owed to National Board: Dues to the National Board shall be \$100 per Sister per year for those Sisters holding Active or Inactive Status. This amount is due to the National Vice President of Finance by October 15th of each year. The Chapter Treasurer is responsible for submitting the Membership Dues form as well as the full amount owed. Alumnae and Active Alumnae are not required to pay National dues.
 3. New Member Dues: Dues for new members who are initiated after October 15th but before the end of the academic school year shall be \$100 per member. New Member Dues are due two weeks after Crossover. The Pledge Mothers are responsible for submitting the New Member Initiation form, and the Chapter Treasurer is responsible for submitting the full amount owed.
 4. Failure to meet financial responsibilities shall result in a fine and the loss of privileges of the corresponding status that the member holds.

Section B. Fines

1. Members of Sigma Omega Nu shall incur monetary penalties or fines for non-compliance to the Bylaws or other deadlines set by the Chapter. See the Chapter Standing Rules for list of fines.
2. Chapters shall incur monetary penalties or fines for non-compliance with the National Board Bylaws or other deadlines set by the National Board. See the National Board Standing Rules for list of fines.

Section C. Member Account Balance Statements

Each member's current account balance statement shall be issued by the Treasurer to each Sister at the first meeting of each month, as well as two weeks prior to any payment deadlines. Late fees shall be imposed upon all unpaid dues and fines.

Section D. Pledgeship Fee

Little Sisters shall pay a non-refundable fee before beginning initiation to Sigma Omega Nu.

Section E. Bounced Checks

Sigma Omega Nu shall reserve the right to charge an additional \$10 fee for any bounced checks.

Section F. Administration of Funds

Any officer or committee chair required to expend Sorority funds in order to fulfill her duties must prepare a Tentative and Final Budget for each event or activity. The Tentative Budget must be prepared and submitted to the Treasurer two weeks prior to the event or activity, and must include all projected expenses as well as projected income. The Final Budget must be prepared and submitted to the Treasurer after the completion of the event or activity. Clear and legible receipts supporting all expenses must be submitted with the Final Budget, as well as a breakdown of how much is to be reimbursed to which Sisters. Income generated, as well as net profit, must also be clearly identified in the Final Budget. Budgets will be reviewed at the next General Meeting after the budget was submitted. Funds shall be administered through the Treasurer, or other officer designated by the Treasurer.

Both Tentative and Final Budgets require a $\frac{3}{4}$ affirmative vote to pass.

Section G. Chapter Bank Account

1. To ensure proper accounting of Chapter funds, the Chapter must establish and maintain an off-campus business bank account with an FDIC-insured financial institution. The off-campus business account must identify the current President and Treasurer as authorized signers. The authorized signers must be updated every time members change positions. The Chapter may also have an on-campus bank account, if desired.
2. Petty cash may be maintained in the form of a physical cash box or in a mobile payment app, but cannot be held in amounts greater than \$500.00. Any amount in excess of \$500 must be deposited into the Chapter's bank account. Funds maintained in petty cash, as well as monies deposited into the Chapter's bank account from petty cash, must be properly accounted for and documented in the Chapter's financial books.
3. The exclusive use of the following to administer Sorority funds is strictly prohibited:
 - a. A Sister's personal bank account
 - b. Peer-to-peer mobile payment apps, such as Venmo, CashApp, or Zelle
 - c. Physical cash

Section H. Notice of Deposit

Any individual of Chapter making a deposit into the National Board account shall notify the National Vice President of Finance of the deposit within 48 hours by sending an email. A copy of the bank/payment receipt signed by the individual making the deposit shall be included in the email, and must clearly show the amount deposited as well as the date and time of deposit. If the notice of deposit is not submitted within 48 hours an automatic late fee will be added to the transaction. Any deposits unaccounted for by the following National Board meeting shall be considered a donation to the National Board.

Article XIV. Academic Honor Society

Section A. Alpha Order

Sigma Omega Nu's Academic Honor Society will bear the name Alpha Order.

Section B. Requirements and Recognition

The requirements and criteria for the Alpha Order are as follows:

1. All candidates for Alpha Order must have a minimum University cumulative grade point average of 3.0.
2. At the end of each academic term, those Active Members with a 3.0 or higher University cumulative grade point average will be inducted into the Alpha Order for the entire length of the following academic term.
3. New Members are eligible for Alpha Order induction if they meet the GPA requirement.
4. These Members will be recognized at the second general meeting of the academic term when they are inducted into of the Alpha Order.
5. These members will be presented with a framed Alpha Order Academic Honor Society certificate.

Section C. Alpha Order Honored Member

1. The Alpha Order inductee with the highest cumulative University grade point average at the end of Winter Quarter or Fall Semester will be recognized as the year's Alpha Order Honored Member.
2. Only Active Members in good standing for the entire academic year are eligible for the Alpha Order Honored Member award.
3. New Members are not eligible for the Alpha Order Honored Member award until they have completed at least one full academic year as an Active Member.
4. The Alpha Order Honored Member will have her name inscribed on the perpetual Alpha Order

plaque. She will also receive the Alpha Order Honored Member Plaque and the Academic Honor Society Scholarship.

Section D. Alpha Order Honored Member Plaque

An individual plaque shall also be presented to the Alpha Order Honored Member, recognizing her accomplishments. The design of the Alpha Order Honored Member Plaque is left to the discretion of the Chapter, but it must have the following words inscribed corresponding to each individual chapter:

Alpha Order
Academic Honor Society
Honored Member
California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo (*full name of University*)
ΣΩΝ Founding Chapter, est. 1996 (*Chapter Name, Chapter Establishment Year*)
(*Name of the plaque recipient*)
(*Quarter/ Semester the recipient was recognized*)

Section E. Academic Honor Society Scholarship

The Vice President and the Commissioner of Alumnae Relations will establish an Academic Honor Society Scholarship funded by contributions from Sigma Omega Nu Alumnae.

1. This scholarship will be awarded yearly to the active Sister with the highest University cumulative grade point average, the Alpha Order recipient.
2. The amount of the Academic Honor Society scholarship will vary from year to year depending on the contributions of the Alumnae.

Section F. Presentation

At the annual Chapter formal, the Vice President shall recognize all members inducted into the Alpha Order for the previous three quarters or two semesters. She shall also present the Alpha Order Honored Member Plaque and the Academic Honor Society Scholarship to the Alpha Order Recipient.

Section G. Alumnae with Honors

1. Any Member who graduates with a 3.0 or higher cumulative grade point average from an accredited four-year University shall be inducted into the Alpha Order of their initiating Chapter following their graduation, in accordance with Section B, above. They shall also be recognized as Alumnae with Honors.
2. These members shall receive an Alpha Order Academic Honor Society certificate stating their status as Alumnae with Honors.

Article XV. Risk Management

The integrity of Sigma Omega Nu is the responsibility of every individual member and Chapter. Failure to comply with risk management policies can result in individual and Chapter disciplinary action, including Chapter suspension and loss of member privileges.

Section A. Standardized Pledgeship and Hazing

1. All Prospective New Members and Little Sisters of Sigma Omega Nu are to be treated with the same level of dignity and respect as initiated members. At no time shall an initiated member of Sigma Omega Nu request or require Little Sisters to perform any act, task or assignment that is considered hazing under University, Local, State or Federal Law.
2. The entire process must fully adhere to the Standardized Pledgeship guidelines, as approved by the

National Board. No Chapter or individual sister may alter or deviate from these guidelines. Pledge Mothers must inform the chapter actives and National Board of any updated University hazing policies that impact the pledgship process. University rules and regulations must be abided by.

3. No member or chapter shall engage in, incite, or encourage any act of hazing involving any member or non-member of Sigma Omega Nu. Engaging in these acts includes willful participation and failure to report hazing.
 - a. Acts of hazing include any action taken or situation created to produce mental or physical discomfort, interpersonal violence, discrimination, embarrassment, harassment or ridicule. Such activities may include, but are not limited to: use of alcohol, paddling in any form, inciting excessive fatigue, morally degrading or humiliating activities, late work sessions which interfere with academic activities, wearing public apparel that is conspicuous and not normally in good taste, and any other activities which are not consistent with the regulations and policies of the educational institution or applicable Local, State, or Federal Law. Permission or approval of person(s) experiencing these acts does not justify hazing.

Section B. Alcohol and Drugs

See also Article XVII. Alcohol & Drug Policy.

1. All recruitment, rush, and pledgship activities associated with any Chapter are prohibited from including any alcohol, illegal drugs, or controlled substances. The presence of these items during these events, whether or not any individual is using them, is also strictly prohibited.
2. The possession, sale, use, or consumption of alcoholic beverages, illegal drug, or controlled substances in any situation sponsored or endorsed by the Chapter, or at any event an observer would associate with the Sorority, must be in compliance with any and all applicable laws of the state, county, city and institution.
3. No alcoholic beverages may be purchased through or with Chapter funds or coordinated by any member in the name of or on behalf of the Chapter and/or Sorority.
4. No members, collectively or individually, shall purchase for, serve to, or sell alcoholic beverages to any minor in accordance with all city, county, state and federal laws.

Section C. Interpersonal Violence and Harassment

The Sorority will not tolerate or condone any form of sexist or abusive behavior on the part of its members, whether physical, mental or emotional. These actions include but not limited to verbal harassment, acts of interpersonal violence, or stalking.

Section D. Sexual Misconduct

1. The Sorority will not tolerate or condone any form of sexual misconduct on the part of its members, whether physical, mental or emotional. Sigma Omega Nu and its members must comply with all federal, state, and local laws related to sexual misconduct.
2. Sexual misconduct includes, but is not limited to:
 - a. Sexual harassment
 - b. The possession, or use, of any “rape drug” with the intent to participate in non-consensual sexual activity.
 - c. The use or distribution of alcohol with the intent of participating in non-consensual sexual activity.
 - d. Non-Consensual Sexual Contact (or attempts to commit same)
 - e. Non-Consensual Sexual Intercourse (or attempts to commit same)
 - f. Sexual Exploitation.
3. This also includes, but is not limited to, definitions around consent, sexual violence, sexual harassment, domestic violence, dating violence, and stalking.

4. Sigma Omega Nu will not support or affiliate with any other organization that tolerates sexual assault or sexual harassment. These organizations will be prohibited from participating in any official Sigma Omega Nu events.
5. Should a member of Sigma Omega Nu be named in an allegation, upon notification Sigma Omega Nu will immediately suspend the member from all official Sorority functions (meetings, events, etc.) and affiliation. The member is to be placed on judicial review by the Chapter and/or the National Board. The member will be suspended until the judicial review process is completed.

Section E. Consequences

1. Members of Sigma Omega Nu who fail to abide by the Risk Management policies shall be subject to review under the Chapter or National Judicial Review process. Judicial consequences may include, but are not limited to being prohibited from contact with potential new members or Little Sisters; loss of specific member privileges; or suspension from Active Membership for a sanctioned amount of time.
2. Any member in violation of any of the above sections at the Chapter level who is not placed under review at the Chapter level shall be placed under review at the National level immediately after the National Board is informed of the violation. Any member in violation of the above Sections during a Prospective Chapter Pledgeship shall be placed under review at the National level. The formal Judicial Review process must still be followed.
3. Cease and Desist Directive: Hazing Allegations
 - a. Definition: A written directive issued by the National Board as a result of a reported hazing allegation that may be in violation of Code of Ethics.
 - b. Purpose: A cease and desist is a directive provided to a chapter to stop alleged illegal activity ("cease") and to not resume pledgeship activities ("desist") indefinitely for the current term or until a determined date (should time allow in the academic term). A cease and desist generates and prompts the judicial review process of the sorority.
 - c. What to expect while on Cease and Desist:
 - i. Written notification from the National President regarding Cease and Desist (C&D). When the National Board has issued a cease-and-desist order to a chapter, the chapter must stop all pledgeship activities until the cease-and-desist order has been lifted. Periodic updates on status of the investigation, if required. The Chapter must cooperate fully and honestly with the NVP of Parliament in all matters related to a Judicial Review process, including providing statements, attendance at a Judicial Review meeting, and any other documentation, upon request.
 - ii. For additional procedural details, refer to the Cease-and-Desist Judicial Review & Procedures section of the official Code of Ethics.
 - d. Activities Permitted with National Board Approval
 - i. During C&D, a Chapter may participate in the following activities only with prior written approval from the National Board.
 1. National Council Meetings
 2. University required activities.
 3. Council required activities.
 4. NALFO required attendance.
 5. Minimal Chapter operations (meetings, community service, fundraisers)
 - a. Chapter meeting minutes must be submitted to the National Vice President of Communications within twenty-four hours following each meeting.
 6. To request approval, the Chapter President must a written request via email

to the National Board detailing the activity or activities for which approval is sought.

- e. Conditional Activities and Reporting Requirements
 - i. For any approved community service, fundraising, or social event, the Chapter must comply with the following requirements:
 - ii. An event report containing full event details must be submitted to the National Board at least two weeks prior to the event for approval to host or participate.
 - 1. Upon approval, the Chapter may proceed only as authorized by the National Board.
 - iii. A final event report must be submitted within twenty-four hours of the event's conclusion.
 - 1. The final event must be signed and dated by the Event Chair and include an accurate member attendance count.
- f. Prohibited Activities
 - i. While under a Cease-and-Desist directive, a Chapter may not engage in the following activities under any circumstances:
 - ii. Recruitment (Rush)
 - iii. Any pledgeship-related activities

Article XVI. Suspension

Section A. Suspension

Any member may be suspended with her privileges withdrawn as a sanction resulting from a formal Judicial Review, or if the member is suspended from the University due to inappropriate actions by the member.

Section B. Restrictions

- 1. Any member under suspension is automatically removed from any office or committee position(s) held, is prohibited from participating in any Sorority functions, and prohibited from using/wearing the name or insignia of Sigma Omega Nu in any way.
 - a. Other sanctions may be added in accordance to the specific reason for suspension (such as account contact payment plans, completion of disciplinary action by the University, etc.).

Section C. Duration

- 1. If a member is suspended as the result of a Judicial Review, the duration of the suspension period shall be unanimously agreed upon by the Judicial Review Committee. Two weeks prior to the end of her suspension period, she must contact the Executive Board to discuss her suspension. If the member has followed the restrictions of her suspension, she may regain full privileges.
- 2. If a member is suspended in conjunction with suspension by the University, the duration of the suspension period shall be the same as that identified by the University. If the University removes the suspension status, the member may regain full privileges.

Section D. Appeal

A member may appeal her suspension to may appeal the decision to the National Board through the Judicial Review Appeal process.

Article XVII. Alcohol & Drug Policy

Section A. Definitions

The following definitions are used within the following article.

1. Sorority funds: any money collected from dues, amounts collected as part of any official Sorority event (e.g., Chapter Formal, part of a ticket to a fundraiser party), and money collected via a fundraiser.
2. Official names of Sigma Omega Nu: any of the three official names specified in the Chapter Bylaws, Article III.

Section B. Sorority Funds

The following shall apply to the use of Sorority funds for the purchase of alcohol.

1. Sorority funds shall not be expended for the purchase of alcohol or any other mind-altering substance or drugs (including prescription drugs).
2. Donations of alcohol shall not be accepted by any member, Chapter, or member of National Board of ΣΩΝ for the purpose of resale.
3. No member nor any Chapter of ΣΩΝ shall accept funds from the direct sale of alcohol by the Sorority, nor in any form that can be viewed as the sorority directly selling alcohol except as defined in Section C below.

Section C. Sorority Events

1. Alcohol shall not be present as part of any official Sorority event unless the Chapter enters into a valid contract with a third-party vendor who holds a valid liquor license for the sale of alcohol. Ceremonies and socials must be formally adjourned before any alcohol is consumed by any person present (not limited to sisters of ΣΩΝ).
2. Alcohol is permitted to be served at official Sorority events if and only if the Chapter enters into a valid contract with a third-party vendor who holds a valid liquor license for the sale of alcohol and who has agreed to properly monitor its distribution for the entire length of the event. The contract must be submitted to the National Director of Social Affairs for review at least 6 weeks prior to the event.
 - a. In the event that a contract is unavailable a minimum of 6 weeks prior to the event for any reason, a letter shall be submitted to the Director of Social Affairs explaining why. The contract must be submitted immediately once signed.
 - b. In the event of a venue change at any time, a letter shall be submitted to the Director of Social Affairs explaining why. An updated contract shall also be submitted.

Section D. Use of Alcohol or Drugs

1. No member of the Sorority is allowed to neither consume any alcoholic beverage nor use any drug in any manner while wearing any paraphernalia of ΣΩΝ. This includes any paraphernalia, including but not limited to attire, jewelry, or drinking glasses, with any of the three official names of the Sorority as identified in Article V. Identification, or with the Sorority or Chapter Crest(s).
2. Any photos of Sisters consuming alcohol or drugs shall not be used in any official publicity of ΣΩΝ. This includes photos of any Sister holding or using anything that may be assumed to be alcohol or drug paraphernalia.
3. Any photos or videos of Sisters wearing any paraphernalia of ΣΩΝ that have tags, captions, stickers, etc. that associate the picture with the use or consumption of alcohol or drugs are strictly prohibited. This includes posts made on official Chapter websites or social media, as well as on the personal websites or social media accounts of individual Sisters.

Section E. Consequences

1. Failure to comply by any of the terms in Sections B and/or C above, as determined by the National Board, shall result in the following:
 - a. The Chapter will be placed under suspension and not allowed to pledge or initiate new

- members for one academic year.
 - b. The Chapter President and Vice President shall immediately be removed from office.
 - c. National Board will seize any funds derived from the sale of alcohol, and donate them to the Chapter's philanthropy.
2. Failure to comply with any of the terms in Section D above shall result in the following consequences:
- a. For National Board members, including Chapter Representatives, this shall result in the inability to wear ΣΩΝ attire for a period of six (6) months.
 - b. For any member, this shall result in the inability to wear ΣΩΝ attire for a period of four (4) months.

Article XVIII. Branding and Publicity Standards

Section A. Overview

The Branding and Publicity Standards apply to all Sigma Omega Nu members who create or contribute to websites, blogs, social networks, or any other kind of social media for Sigma Omega Nu, nationally or locally. These standards are intended to ensure compliance with all the Sorority's applicable rules, Bylaws, Standing Rules, Standardized Pledgeship, and Code of Ethics when the Sorority participates in online digital and social media sites. These sites include, but are not limited to, Facebook, Twitter, Myspace, Instagram, YouTube, or LinkedIn. While these standards are mandatory for Chapters to follow, all members are encouraged to follow them on their own personal websites or accounts for any content that includes or references the Sorority.

Section B. Official Sigma Omega Nu Outlets

Sigma Omega Nu's National main social media sites include:

1. Website: officialsigmaomeganu.org
2. Facebook: facebook.com/sigmaomeganu
3. Instagram: instagram.com/sigmaomeganu
4. LinkedIn: linkedin.com/company/sigma-omega-nu-latina-interest-sorority-inc

Each Chapter is encouraged to maintain a Chapter website, Facebook page, and Instagram account.

Section C. Other Social Media Sites

If a Chapter creates a new profile, group or page on any social media outlet not identified above, the Commissioner of Public Relations must notify the National Social Media Manager of the new platform and account. This will keep the National Board aware of new trends in social media, while also providing them with the opportunity to share Chapter content from the corresponding National account.

Section D. Branding

Sigma Omega Nu has graphics optimized for the creation of print and digital content. When used consistently, symbols such as the Crest and La Mujer can help the audience easily identify the Sorority. The National Director of Branding and Publicity can assist Chapters with creating this content.

Section E. Unacceptable Content and Terminology to Avoid

Content posted must be appropriate in nature and should not include the following:

1. Alcoholic beverages or drug paraphernalia, in accordance with the Alcohol & Drug Policy
2. Any written or graphic references to alcohol or drugs, or references to the consumption of alcohol or drugs.
3. Illegal activities or behavior inconsistent with the policies, values, and the Objectives of Sigma Omega Nu.
4. Anything prohibited by the Pledgeship Privacy Policy, as identified in Standardized Pledgeship.

5. Distasteful or offensive photos, graphics, audio, video and automated presentations.
6. Detailed Chapter meeting minutes that include confidential information.
7. Logos, graphics, data, and other items with registered trademarks without legal permission for use or reproduction.

Article XIX. Advisor

Section A. Qualifications

An advisor of Sigma Omega Nu may be a university faculty or staff member, who has been unanimously approved by all Active Members. All Sigma Omega Nu advisors shall be required to attend a workshop designed to provide information about our organization.

Section B. Incorporation and Representation

Efforts to incorporate our advisors as a valuable part of this organization shall include:

1. Invitation to attend the last meeting of each month during the academic school year.
2. Invitations to attend any events related to fundraising, community service, cultura, or academics.
3. Assistance in any conflicts that may arise within Sigma Omega Nu and with other organizations and members of the community. Advisor assistance will only be requested with the permission of the parties involved in the conflict.

Advisor paraphernalia can be utilized only in the specified manner of: "Sigma Omega Nu, Advisor".

Paraphernalia with Greek letters and/or Sorority nicknames are not permitted. All activities involving advisors must also follow the risk management policies.

Section C. Recognition

The advisor(s) shall be recognized in the form of an award or some other expression of gratitude for the help and guidance provided during the year. This may be presented at the annual formal.

Article XX. Standing Rules

For better understanding of the Bylaws or Sigma Omega Nu procedures Chapters shall refer to the Standing Rules.

Article XXI. Amendments

Any Active Member of Sigma Omega Nu may suggest changes to the Chapter Bylaws. These suggestions must be presented to the Chapter in standard proposal form. The Active Member is to present the proposal at the next scheduled General Meeting wherein changes and amendments may be made to the proposal. Once the proposal has been finalized, it must pass by a simple majority vote of the Active Members of the Chapter. The Chapter then must present their proposal to the National Board. The National Board must approve all changes before they can be finalized and incorporated into the Chapter Bylaws.

Article XXII. Conflict

These Bylaws shall be in accordance with all University codes, regulations, and policies.